

HelixQA Go-Package Linking Design (Phase 4 Follow-up C — Lava-side)

Date: 2026-05-16 **Phase:** 4 follow-up C (Option 2 from docs/plans/2026-05-16-helixqa-integration-design.md) **Status:** Design proposal — operator approval required before implementation begins **HelixQA pin:** 403603db (v4.0.0-256-g403603d) as of Phase 4 adoption commit aa0db6bd **HelixQA module path:** `digital.vasic.helixqa` (per `submodules/helixqa/go.mod`) **Classification:** project-specific (the per-package adapter choices + Lava-side file paths are project-specific; the adapter-interface boundary-isolation discipline is universal per HelixConstitution §11.4.31)

Scope

This design covers **Option 2** from the parent integration design doc — Go-package linking of HelixQA's **Group A** packages (detector, evidence, navigator, validator, ticket) into Lava's Go service (`lava-api-go`). It is **DESIGN-ONLY**. No Go code changes; no `lava-api-go/go.mod` modifications; no scripts changes. Option 1 (shell-level wiring of 11 Challenge scripts) is ALREADY IMPLEMENTED (commits 1b66d192 + d94ade0d). Option 3 (Compose UI Challenge Test backend migration) remains deferred.

A. Integration entry point decision

A.1 — `lava-api-go` is the natural Go-side integration point

Lava ships two distributable artifacts plus a third in-flight:

- `:app` — Android client (Kotlin + Compose). Cannot directly import Go packages without subprocess invocation OR gRPC bridge OR JNI. All three impose substantial overhead.
- `:proxy` — Ktor/Netty headless JVM server (Kotlin). Same limitation as `:app`.
- `lava-api-go` — Go service (Go 1.25, Gin, Postgres). **Native Go consumer**. Can import HelixQA packages directly.

The DESIGN DECISION is: **Phase 4-C-1 through 4-C-4 target lava-api-go ONLY.** Adapters live under `lava-api-go/internal/qa/`. The Android client and Ktor proxy are NOT touched by this phase.

A.2 — Why not the Android client (deferred)

Three architectural options were considered for Android-side HelixQA consumption; each is deferred pending Phase 4-C-1..4 proving value:

1. **Subprocess invocation.** Android instrumentation test invokes the `helixqa` CLI via `adb shell` against the test host. Slow (process startup overhead per assertion), and the binary must be present on the test host — a deployment burden. Defer.
2. **gRPC bridge.** `lava-api-go` exposes the HelixQA adapters via gRPC; the Android client speaks gRPC during instrumentation tests. Adds architectural complexity (gRPC stubs, protocol versioning, transport security inside test runs). Defer.
3. **JNI bindings to a Go-compiled-as-shared-library.** Use `go build -buildmode=c-shared` to produce a `.so` consumable by Android's JNI. Build-time complexity, ABI fragility across Android NDK versions. Defer indefinitely.

Phase 4-C scope: Go-side only. Phase 4-C-5 (hypothetical, not in this design's mandated scope) MAY later evaluate Android-side wiring once the Go-side adapters prove stable.

A.3 — Why not the Ktor proxy

The Ktor `:proxy` is being replaced by `lava-api-go` per SP-2. Adding HelixQA wiring to a deprecated artifact is anti-value. SKIP entirely.

B. Per-package integration plan for Group A

For each Group A package, the design covers: (1) HelixQA's exported public API (recovered by reading `submodules/helixqa/pkg/<name>/*.go` at pin 403603db); (2) the Lava use case the package addresses; (3) the Lava-side adapter-interface design; (4) the proposed file path; (5) the testing strategy.

B.1 — pkg/detector

Public API (HelixQA pin 403603db)

```
// Types
type DetectionResult struct {
    Platform    config.Platform
```

```

    HasCrash      bool
    HasANR        bool           // Android-only
    ProcessAlive  bool
    StackTrace    string
    // ... (plus fields for evidence + console + crash details)
}

type CommandRunner interface {
    Run(ctx context.Context, name string, args ...string)
        ([]byte, error)
}

type Detector struct { /* opaque */ }

type Option func(*Detector)

// Functional-options constructor
func New(platform config.Platform, opts ...Option) *Detector
func WithDevice(device string) Option           // Android
    emulator/device ID
func WithPackageName(pkg string) Option         // Android app
    package
func WithBrowserURL(url string) Option          // Web target
func WithProcessName(name string) Option        // Desktop/JVM/Go
    target
func WithProcessPID(pid int) Option             // Same, by PID
func WithEvidenceDir(dir string) Option
func WithCommandRunner(runner CommandRunner) Option // ←
    injection seam for tests

// Methods
func (d *Detector) Check(ctx context.Context) (*DetectionResult,
    error)
func (d *Detector) CheckApp(ctx context.Context, /* per-platform
    args */) (*DetectionResult, error)
func (d *Detector) Platform() config.Platform

```

Lava use case

- **lava-api-go process monitoring** during integration test runs (Phase 4b's chaos / DDoS / sustained-load scenarios benefit from crash detection on the API process itself).
- **Future cross-platform extension:** if Lava ships a desktop QA harness, pkg/detector covers JVM + browser targets natively.

Lava-side adapter

File: lava-api-go/internal/qa/detector/adapter.go (proposed)

package detector

import (

```

    "context"
    "digital.vasic.helixqa/pkg/config"
    hxqadetector "digital.vasic.helixqa/pkg/detector"
)

// CrashDetector is Lava's abstraction over HelixQA's Detector.
// Adapter pattern: HelixQA version bumps only touch this file,
// not Lava's call sites.
type CrashDetector interface {
    CheckGoProcess(ctx context.Context, processName string)
        (*Report, error)
}

// Report is Lava's flattened/renamed view of HelixQA's
// DetectionResult – only the fields Lava cares about.
type Report struct {
    Crashed    bool
    Alive      bool
    StackTrace string
    EvidencePath string
}

// Adapter wraps a HelixQA Detector.
type Adapter struct {
    detector *hxqadetector.Detector
}

// New creates the adapter wired to HelixQA's Linux/host detector.
func New(evidenceDir string) *Adapter { /* construct */ }

func (a *Adapter) CheckGoProcess(ctx context.Context, processName
    string) (*Report, error) {
    // 1. configure HelixQA detector with WithProcessName +
    //    WithEvidenceDir
    // 2. invoke detector.Check(ctx)
    // 3. translate hxqadetector.DetectionResult →
    //    qadetector.Report
    // 4. RecordNonFatal on error per §6.AC
}

```

Testing strategy

- **Adapter unit test** (lava-api-go/internal/qa/detector/adapter_test.go): inject a fake CommandRunner that returns canned ps/pgrep output; assert adapter maps fields correctly.
 - **Falsifiability rehearsal**: mutate the field mapping (e.g., Crashed = !dr.HasCrash) and confirm the assertion fails.
 - **Real-stack test** (lava-api-go/internal/qa/detector/adapter_real_test.go, gated by -tags=helixqa_realstack): launch a sacrificial cat /dev/zero & process, assert detector reports Alive=true; kill it; assert Alive=false.
-

B.2 — pkg/evidence

Public API

```
// Types
type Type string

const (
    TypeScreenshot Type = "screenshot"
    TypeVideo       Type = "video"
    TypeLogcat      Type = "logcat"
    TypeStackTrace  Type = "stacktrace"
    TypeConsoleLog  Type = "console_log"
    TypeAudio       Type = "audio"
)

type Item struct {
    Type      Type
    Path      string
    Platform  config.Platform
    Step      string
    Timestamp time.Time
    // ... plus metadata
}

type Collector struct { /* opaque */ }

type Option func(*Collector)

func New(opts ...Option) *Collector
func WithOutputDir(dir string) Option
func WithPlatform(p config.Platform) Option
func WithCommandRunner(r detector.CommandRunner) Option

// Capture methods (subset)
func (c *Collector) CaptureScreenshot(ctx context.Context, name string) (*Item, error)
func (c *Collector) CaptureLogcat(ctx context.Context, name string, lines int) (*Item, error)
func (c *Collector) StartRecording(ctx context.Context, name string) error
func (c *Collector) StopRecording(ctx context.Context) (*Item, error)
func (c *Collector) StartAudioRecording(ctx context.Context, name string) error
func (c *Collector) StopAudioRecording(ctx context.Context) (*Item, error)
func (c *Collector) Items() []Item
func (c *Collector) Reset()
```

Lava use case

- **lava-api-go integration tests** need failure evidence captured uniformly (current state: each test scatters its own ad-hoc `os.WriteFile("/tmp/...")` calls).
- **Phase 4b's load + chaos test types** produce evidence (HTTP traces, log dumps, performance graphs); a unified collector with typed `Item` records makes the per-cell coverage-ledger entries (Phase 7) machine-readable.
- **Cross-language uniformity**: if the Kotlin side later adopts a JVM equivalent, the typed evidence schema can be shared.

Lava-side adapter

File: `lava-api-go/internal/qa/evidence/adapter.go`

```
package evidence
```

```
import (  
    "context"  
    hxqaevidence "digital.vasic.helixqa/pkg/evidence"  
    "digital.vasic.helixqa/pkg/config"  
)  
  
// Recorder is Lava's abstraction over HelixQA's Collector.  
type Recorder interface {  
    CaptureText(ctx context.Context, name, content string) error  
    CaptureLogs(ctx context.Context, name string, lines int) error  
    Snapshot() []EvidenceItem  
    Reset()  
}  
  
// EvidenceItem is Lava's view of HelixQA's Item (without  
// Android-specific Platform field – Lava server-side is Linux).  
type EvidenceItem struct {  
    Kind      string // "log" | "trace" | "stacktrace" | "metric"  
    Path      string  
    Step      string  
    Timestamp time.Time  
}  
  
type Adapter struct {  
    collector *hxqaevidence.Collector  
}  
  
func New(outputDir string) *Adapter { /* construct with Linux  
    Platform */ }  
  
func (a *Adapter) CaptureText(ctx context.Context, name, content  
    string) error {  
    // 1. Write content to outputDir
```

```

// 2. Call HelixQA's addItem equivalent (via a public method
//    we may need to add upstream)
//    OR: bypass HelixQA's collector for text and just track
//    in Lava's own slice
// 3. RecordNonFatal on error per §6.AC
}

```

HONEST CAVEAT: pkg/evidence's public surface centers on Android adb screencap + adb screenrecord + adb logcat + Android-side screencap for desktops. **For lava-api-go server-side use cases (log capture, trace capture, metric snapshots), HelixQA's Collector is partially overkill.** The pragmatic path is: use HelixQA's Item schema + Reset/Items lifecycle, but emit CaptureText via Lava-side direct write (not through HelixQA's addItem which is currently unexported). Future Phase 4-C-1.b MAY request HelixQA upstream expose a CaptureGeneric(ctx, kind, name, contents) method — that is an UPSTREAM contribution, not a Lava-side hack.

Testing strategy

- **Adapter unit test** (adapter_test.go): instantiate adapter pointing at t.TempDir(); capture text; assert file written + Item recorded.
 - **Falsifiability rehearsal:** mutate the file-write path to /dev/null; assert subsequent Snapshot() returns empty + adapter records non-fatal via §6.AC.
 - **Concurrency test:** parallel CaptureText calls; assert no item loss + no duplicate paths.
-

B.3 — pkg/ticket

Public API

```

// Types
type VideoReference struct {
    VideoPath    string
    Timestamp    time.Duration
    Description   string
}

type LLMSuggestedFix struct {
    Description   string
    CodeSnippet  string
    Confidence    float64    // 0.0-1.0
    AffectedFiles []string
}

type Severity string

const (

```

```

        SeverityCritical Severity = "critical"
        SeverityHigh      Severity = "high"
        SeverityMedium    Severity = "medium"
        SeverityLow       Severity = "low"
    )

    type Ticket struct {
        ID            string
        Title         string
        Severity      Severity
        Platform      config.Platform
        TestCaseID    string
        Description    string
        StepsToReproduce []string
        // ... plus VideoReference + LLMsuggestedFix + StackTrace +
        // Evidence
    }

    type Generator struct { /* opaque */ }

    func New(opts ...Option) *Generator
    func WithOutputDir(dir string) Option

    // Methods
    func (g *Generator) GenerateFromStep(sr *validator.StepResult,
        testCaseID string) *Ticket
    func (g *Generator) GenerateFromDetection(dr
        *detector.DetectionResult, context string) *Ticket
    func (g *Generator) WriteTicket(t *Ticket) (string, error) //
        // returns markdown path
    func (g *Generator) WriteAll(tickets []*Ticket) ([]string, error)
    func (g *Generator) RenderMarkdown(t *Ticket) []byte

```

Lava use case

- **Replaces Lava's §6.O Crashlytics closure log MANUAL authoring with generated markdown.** Today every fix lands a hand-written `.lava-ci-evidence/crashlytics-resolved/<date>-<slug>.md`. HelixQA's Ticket schema + RenderMarkdown produces those files mechanically from detector/validator inputs.
- **Generates fix-pipeline-readable markdown** that AI-assisted fix tools (Claude Code, etc.) consume directly without operator transcription.
- **Bridges crash-detection (B.1) and step-validation (B.5) into actionable artifacts.**

Lava-side adapter

File: `lava-api-go/internal/qa/ticket/adapter.go`

```
package ticket
```

```

import (
    hxqaticket "digital.vasic.helixqa/pkg/ticket"
    hxqadetector "digital.vasic.helixqa/pkg/detector"
    qadetector "digital.vasic.lava.apigo/internal/qa/detector"
)

// ClosureLogWriter is Lava's abstraction; covers §6.0 closure-log
// authoring without operator transcription.
type ClosureLogWriter interface {
    WriteFromCrash(crashlyticsID string, report
        *qadetector.Report) (string, error)
    WriteFromValidationFailure(...) (string, error)
}

type Adapter struct {
    generator *hxqaticket.Generator
}

func New(outputDir string) *Adapter { /* construct */ }

func (a *Adapter) WriteFromCrash(crashlyticsID string, report
    *qadetector.Report) (string, error) {
    // 1. Translate qadetector.Report →
    //    hxqadetector.DetectionResult
    //    (note: this is the REVERSE direction of B.1's
    //    translation)
    // 2. Call a.generator.GenerateFromDetection(dr, "Crashlytics
    //    issue: " + crashlyticsID)
    // 3. Augment ticket with Lava-specific metadata (Crashlytics
    //    issue link, §6.0 reference)
    // 4. Call a.generator.WriteTicket(ticket) → returns path
    // 5. Path SHOULD be .lava-ci-evidence/crashlytics-resolved/
    //    <id>-<slug>.md to satisfy §6.0
}

```

Testing strategy

- **Adapter unit test:** synthetic Report → call adapter → assert markdown file written with required §6.0 fields (Crashlytics ID, root cause, stack trace, fix-commit-SHA placeholder).
 - **Falsifiability rehearsal:** mutate the markdown template to omit the Crashlytics ID: header; assert the test (which checks for that header) fails.
 - **§6.0 compliance test:** after adapter writes ticket, invoke scripts/check-constitution.sh against the generated file; assert no violations.
-

B.4 — pkg/navigator

Public API

```
// Types
type NavigationEngine struct { /* opaque */ }

func NewNavigationEngine(
    ag agent.Agent,
    az analyzer.Analyzer,
    exec ActionExecutor,
    navGraph graph.NavigationGraph,
) *NavigationEngine

// Methods
func (ne *NavigationEngine) NavigateTo(...) (...)
func (ne *NavigationEngine) PerformAction(...) (...)
func (ne *NavigationEngine) ExploreUnknown(...) (...)
func (ne *NavigationEngine) CurrentScreen() ...
func (ne *NavigationEngine) GoBack() error
func (ne *NavigationEngine) GoHome() error
func (ne *NavigationEngine) State() *StateTracker
func (ne *NavigationEngine) Graph() graph.NavigationGraph

// Executor interface (per-platform)
type ActionExecutor interface {
    Click(ctx context.Context, x, y int) error
    Type(ctx context.Context, text string) error
    Clear(ctx context.Context) error
    Scroll(ctx context.Context, direction string, amount int)
        error
    LongPress(ctx context.Context, x, y int, durationMs int) error
    // ... screenshot + others
}

// Provided executors
type ADBExecutor struct { /* opaque */ }
func NewADBExecutor(device string, runner detector.CommandRunner)
    *ADBExecutor

// Plus: PlaywrightExecutor (web), X11Executor (Linux desktop),
    CLIExecutor (terminal)
```

Lava use case

- **PRIMARILY ANDROID-FACING.** lava-api-go is a backend service with no UI to navigate. Direct Go-side value is low.
- **INDIRECT VALUE:** if Phase 4-C eventually grows an Android-side bridge (per A.2), pkg/navigator becomes the canonical UI driver for replacing Espresso. But Phase 4-C is Go-side ONLY.

- **POSSIBLE USE FOR LATER ANDROID PHASE:** lava-api-go MAY expose a navigation-trace logging endpoint that Android tests POST to, providing a server-side navigation graph view. Speculative; deferred.

Lava-side adapter

DEFERRED to Phase 4-C-4 (LAST priority). No Lava-side Go-only use case justifies the adapter today. The adapter would be empty plumbing without a real consumer.

If Phase 4-C-4 proceeds, the proposed shape is:

File: lava-api-go/internal/qa/navigator/adapter.go

```
package navigator

// NavigationTraceRecorder accepts navigation-trace POSTs from
// the Android client during instrumentation tests + persists them
// to the qa evidence store.
type NavigationTraceRecorder interface {
    RecordTransition(ctx context.Context, from, to string, action
        string) error
    Snapshot() *NavigationGraph
}
```

Testing strategy (when implemented)

- **Adapter unit test:** synthetic transition POSTs; assert graph state matches.
- **Falsifiability rehearsal:** corrupt the from→to mapping; assert graph diff detects.

B.5 — pkg/validator

Public API

```
// Types
type StepStatus string

const (
    StepPassed  StepStatus = "passed"
    StepFailed  StepStatus = "failed"
    StepSkipped StepStatus = "skipped"
    StepError   StepStatus = "error"
)

type StepResult struct {
    StepName string
```

```

    Status          StepStatus
    Platform        config.Platform
    Detection        *detector.DetectionResult
    PreScreenshot    string
    PostScreenshot   string
    // ... plus timestamps + error info
}

type ScreenshotFunc func(ctx context.Context, name string)
                      (string, error)

type Validator struct { /* opaque */ }

func New(...) *Validator // takes detector + options
func WithEvidenceDir(dir string) Option
func WithScreenshotFunc(fn ScreenshotFunc) Option

// Methods
func (v *Validator) ValidateStep(ctx context.Context, stepName
    string, platform config.Platform) (*StepResult, error)
func (v *Validator) Results() []*StepResult
func (v *Validator) PassedCount() int
func (v *Validator) FailedCount() int
func (v *Validator) TotalCount() int
func (v *Validator) Reset()

```

Lava use case

- **Step-by-step validation for lava-api-go integration test scenarios** — e.g., Phase 4b's chaos / DDoS / sustained-load scenarios that run multi-step interactions against the API. Each step gets a StepResult with crash detection + evidence.
- **Per-step screenshot/log capture** wires into B.2 (evidence collector) — the ScreenshotFunc becomes a thin wrapper around the evidence adapter.
- **Aggregates into B.3 (ticket)** — Validator.Results() feeds Generator.GenerateFromStep().

Lava-side adapter

File: lava-api-go/internal/qa/validator/adapter.go

```
package validator
```

```
import (
    hxqavalidator "digital.vasic.helixqa/pkg/validator"
    qadetector    "digital.vasic.lava.apigo/internal/qa/detector"
    qaevidence     "digital.vasic.lava.apigo/internal/qa/evidence"
)
```

```
// StepRunner is Lava's abstraction; bundles HelixQA validator
```

```

// + Lava-specific evidence capture.
type StepRunner interface {
    Run(ctx context.Context, stepName string, fn func() error)
        (*StepReport, error)
    Summary() Summary
}

type StepReport struct {
    Name      string
    Passed    bool
    Duration  time.Duration
    Evidence  []qaevidence.EvidenceItem
    Crash     *qadetector.Report
}

type Adapter struct {
    validator *hxqavalidator.Validator
    detector  *qadetector.Adapter
    evidence  *qaevidence.Adapter
}

func New(...) *Adapter { /* wire all three */ }

func (a *Adapter) Run(ctx context.Context, stepName string, fn
    func() error) (*StepReport, error) {
    // 1. Take pre-step evidence snapshot
    // 2. Execute fn() – the actual step work
    // 3. Take post-step evidence snapshot
    // 4. Invoke a.validator.ValidateStep to check for crashes
        during fn()
    // 5. Aggregate into StepReport
    // 6. RecordNonFatal on any error path per §6.AC
}

```

Testing strategy

- **Adapter unit test:** step that succeeds → assert StepReport.Passed=true; step that returns error → assert Passed=false + crash report optional.
- **Falsifiability rehearsal:** mutate pass/fail logic (e.g., always return Passed=true); assert assertion catches.
- **Real-stack test:** chain B.1 + B.2 + B.5 adapters; run a deliberately-crashing scenario; assert StepReport correctly reports crash + captures evidence.

C. lava-api-go go.mod strategy

C.1 — Module path consistency

HelixQA's submodules/helixqa/go.mod declares module `digital.vasic.helixqa`. This matches the prefix Lava's other submodules use (`digital.vasic.auth`, `digital.vasic.cache`, etc.) per the existing replace block in `lava-api-go/go.mod` lines 5-21. **No naming conflict.** HelixQA can be added to the same replace block.

C.2 — Sibling-directory replace directive (local development)

Add to `lava-api-go/go.mod`:

```
replace (
    // ... existing 16 lines ...
    digital.vasic.helixqa => ../submodules/helixqa
)

require (
    // ... existing requires ...
    digital.vasic.helixqa v0.0.0-00010101000000-000000000000
)
```

The `v0.0.0-00010101000000-000000000000` pseudo-version is HelixQA's pre-release marker — same pattern as `digital.vasic.cache v0.0.0-00010101000000-000000000000` already in the file (line 30).

C.3 — Pinned-tag dependency (release builds)

For release builds (lava-api-go binary distributed to a container registry per §6.P), the dependency MUST resolve to a real tag, NOT the sibling-directory replace. HelixQA's README.md cites `v4.0.0`; current pin `403603db` is `v4.0.0-256-g403603d`. Two paths:

Path A — Pin to a tagged release.

- Bump HelixQA pin to a tag (e.g., `v4.0.0` proper)
- `lava-api-go/go.mod` uses `require digital.vasic.helixqa v4.0.0` WITHOUT a replace directive
- Release builds resolve directly from the upstream module proxy

Path B — Continue with replace + pin SHA.

- Keep the replace `digital.vasic.helixqa => ../submodules/helixqa` line

- Release-build container ALSO includes submodules/helixqa/ in its context (mount or COPY)
- Same go.mod shape works for both dev and release

Recommendation: Path B for Phase 4-C-1. It avoids coupling to HelixQA's tag cadence (HelixQA is in active development per its IMMEDIATE_EXECUTION_PLAN.md). Migrate to Path A once HelixQA reaches release stability.

C.4 — Transitive dependency cost (open concern)

HelixQA's go.mod (pin 403603db) requires Go 1.26 (Lava is on 1.25).

POTENTIAL VERSION CONFLICT. Two responses:

1. Bump lava-api-go's Go toolchain to 1.26 (recommended — Go 1.26 is current; 1.25 is fine but trailing).
2. Patch HelixQA's go.mod locally to go 1.25 — risky, may surface incompatibilities.

The Go-version delta is the first concrete operator-decision blocker. Recorded in §G open questions.

HelixQA also pulls heavy transitive deps (Playwright Go bindings, OpenCV bridges, GStreamer, ML model runtime libs per the pkg/ survey). Adding HelixQA to lava-api-go/go.mod will **substantially grow** the build cache + binary size. Per §6.T.2 (Resource Limits): the impact on lava-api-go's container image size + CI build time needs measurement before merge. Recorded as a Phase 4-C-1 acceptance criterion.

D. CI gate integration

D.1 — Existing tests must NOT break

lava-api-go currently has tests/contract/, tests/e2e/, tests/parity/ + per-package unit tests. Adding HelixQA as a dependency MUST NOT break any existing test. The Phase 4-C-1 commit MUST run:

```
cd lava-api-go && make test
cd lava-api-go && make integration # gated by -tags=integration
```

Both must pass after the dependency addition, BEFORE any adapter code lands.

D.2 — Adapter unit tests

Each adapter (B.1 detector, B.2 evidence, B.3 ticket, B.5 validator) ships with a unit test in the same package:

```
lava-api-go/internal/qa/detector/adapter_test.go
lava-api-go/internal/qa/evidence/adapter_test.go
lava-api-go/internal/qa/ticket/adapter_test.go
lava-api-go/internal/qa/validator/adapter_test.go
```

Each test follows the §6.A real-binary contract pattern: real adapter + fake CommandRunner (HelixQA's documented test injection point). Falsifiability rehearsal recorded per §6.J in the commit body.

D.3 — Real-stack integration tests

Per §6.J + §6.AE: each adapter needs at least ONE end-to-end real-stack test. Proposed location:

```
lava-api-go/internal/qa/<package>/adapter_real_test.go
```

Build-tag gated: `//go:build helixqa_realstack`. Default test runs skip them (transitive HelixQA deps may not be present in lightweight CI environments).

D.4 — Per-adapter CI gate registration

The Lava verify-all sweep (`scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh`) MUST gain a new gate:

```
| CM-HELIXQA-ADAPTER-COVERAGE | every adapter has unit test +
real-stack test (build-tag gated)
```

Implemented as: `walk lava-api-go/internal/qa/*/;` for each, assert `adapter_test.go` exists AND a `*_real_test.go` exists with the `helixqa_realstack` build tag. Add to `scripts/check-constitution.sh` after Phase 4-C-1 lands.

E. Phased rollout proposal

The four-phase rollout is risk-ordered (smallest API surface first, deepest integration last).

E.1 — Phase 4-C-1: pkg/evidence first

Why first: smallest API surface (Collector + Item + a handful of capture methods), lowest risk (server-side text + log capture is well-understood), proves the go.mod + adapter pattern without depending on other adapters.

Deliverables:

- lava-api-go/internal/qa/evidence/adapter.go + _test.go + _real_test.go
- lava-api-go/go.mod adds digital.vasic.helixqa dependency
- scripts/check-constitution.sh gains CM-HELIXQA-ADAPTER-COVERAGE (in advisory mode)
- Go-version conflict resolution (per §C.4)
- §6.AC non-fatal telemetry coverage on every catch block
- §6.J falsifiability rehearsal recorded in commit body

Acceptance criteria:

- make test + make integration PASS
- make integration -tags=helixqa_realstack PASS
- lava-api-go binary size delta measured + recorded
- §6.AC coverage scan reports 0 violations
- §6.AC waivers (if any) documented per docs/helix-constitution-gates.md

Estimated scope: 1 session.

E.2 — Phase 4-C-2: pkg/detector

Why second: Android-adjacent (high Lava strategic value), proven by B.1's design, depends on the §C dep-pattern already established by 4-C-1.

Deliverables (additive on top of 4-C-1):

- lava-api-go/internal/qa/detector/adapter.go + _test.go + _real_test.go
- §6.AC coverage + §6.J falsifiability rehearsal

Acceptance criteria: Same as 4-C-1 + adapter unit test passes against a fake CommandRunner + real-stack test passes against a sacrificial process.

Estimated scope: 1 session.

E.3 — Phase 4-C-3: pkg/ticket

Why third: depends on 4-C-2 (Detector adapter's Report type feeds into Ticket adapter's WriteFromCrash). REPLACES Lava's §6.O Crashlytics closure-log MANUAL authoring with generated markdown — high operator-visible value.

Deliverables (additive):

- `lava-api-go/internal/qa/ticket/adapter.go + _test.go + _real_test.go`
- Migration of `.lava-ci-evidence/crashlytics-resolved/<id>-<slug>.md` **AUTHORING** from operator-handwritten to ticket-adapter-generated (the EXISTING closure logs stay untouched; only NEW ones use the adapter)
- §6.O compliance test asserts adapter-generated tickets satisfy the closure-log contract

Acceptance criteria: Same as prior + adapter-generated tickets pass `scripts/check-constitution.sh`.

Estimated scope: 1 session.

E.4 — Phase 4-C-4: pkg/navigator + pkg/validator

Why last (jointly): deepest integration; pkg/navigator has weak Go-side justification (per B.4); pkg/validator only earns its keep when 4-C-2 + 4-C-3 are in place to feed it.

Deliverables:

- `lava-api-go/internal/qa/validator/adapter.go + tests + real-stack test`
- `lava-api-go/internal/qa/navigator/adapter.go` — RECONSIDERED at start of 4-C-4: if no Go-side consumer materializes, SKIP. Document the skip with rationale + revisit-trigger.
- Full E2E test: detector + evidence + validator + ticket wired together; run a deliberately-crashing scenario; assert ticket file written with all evidence linked.

Acceptance criteria: Same as prior + full chain passes the end-to-end test.

Estimated scope: 1-2 sessions (validator: 1; navigator: 0-1 depending on operator decision).

F. §6.J anti-bluff posture

Every phase MUST satisfy ALL of:

F.1 — Per-adapter falsifiability rehearsal (§6.J.2)

Each adapter commit body MUST contain a Bluff-Audit stamp recording:

- The mutation deliberately introduced (e.g., "flipped Crashed field assignment from `dr.HasCrash` to `!dr.HasCrash`")
- The observed failure message from the adapter test against the mutation
- Reverted: yes

F.2 — §6.AC non-fatal telemetry coverage

Every adapter's catch path MUST call `observability.RecordNonFatal(ctx, err, attrs)` per §6.AC. Specifically:

- `HelixQA` API error → translate + record
- `os.MkdirAll` / file-write error → record
- `context.DeadlineExceeded` → record

Adapter commits land §6.AC waivers ONLY if `HelixQA`'s API surface forces a deliberate ignore (e.g., the underlying call is fire-and-forget); waivers go in `docs/helix-constitution-gates.md` with rationale.

F.3 — `HELIX_DEV_OWNED` waiver lifecycle (Phase 4 follow-up B carryover)

Phase 4 follow-up B (commit `d94ade0d`) added the `HELIX_DEV_OWNED` waiver pattern for 4 existing scanners (where the scanner would have flagged `HelixQA` but does not, because `HelixQA` is `HelixDevelopment`-owned and the scanner is `vasic-digital-org`-scoped). Phase 4-C MUST audit whether ANY adapter integration commit allows a `HelixQA` gate-check to flip from `HELIX_DEV_OWNED` waived → actually-enforced (e.g., a Lava-side test now exists that exercises a `HelixQA`-internal invariant).

If any such transition occurs, the waiver MUST be removed in the same commit + the scanner MUST start enforcing. This is the §6.J version of "honest scope statements" — keeping waivers when the underlying need is gone is a documentation bluff.

F.4 — Real-stack test honesty

Per §6.J.5: the build-tag-gated real-stack tests (per §D.3) MUST actually run in at least one Phase 4-C cycle. Source-compile is NOT execution per §6.Z. The cycle's commit body MUST contain captured `go test -tags=helixqa_realstack` output as inline evidence OR a path to `.lava-ci-evidence/phase-4-c/<phase>-real-stack-evidence.log`.

G. Open questions for operator (decisions blocking Phase 4-C-1)

The following decisions MUST be made before Phase 4-C-1 implementation begins. Each is non-trivial; defaulting silently is itself a §6.J bluff.

- 1. Go-version conflict (§C.4):** HelixQA requires Go 1.26; lava-api-go is on Go 1.25. Operator decision:
 - (a) bump lava-api-go to Go 1.26 (recommended)
 - (b) patch HelixQA's go 1.25 directive locally (risky)
 - (c) defer Phase 4-C entirely until HelixQA lowers its Go floor
- 2. Adapter strategy: WRAP vs RE-EXPORT (§B):** Adapters as designed WRAP HelixQA types into Lava-shaped types
`(Adapter.WriteFromCrash(crashlyticsID, *qadetector.Report)`
instead of
`Adapter.GenerateFromDetection(*hxqadetector.DetectionResult))`.
Trade-off:
 - (a) WRAP (recommended): API stability against HelixQA changes; minor translation overhead
 - (b) RE-EXPORT: zero translation cost; ANY HelixQA API change breaks Lava
- 3. Release-mode dependency resolution (§C.3):** Path A (tag-pin) or Path B (replace + sibling-mount in release containers).
- 4. Per-adapter naming: keep HelixQA terminology vs Lava-domain terminology:** Detector → CrashDetector (renamed) vs Detector (preserved); Collector → Recorder (renamed) vs Collector (preserved); Generator → ClosureLogWriter (renamed) vs Generator (preserved).
Trade-off: discoverability for HelixQA-familiar developers (preserve) vs domain clarity for Lava-only developers (rename).

5. **HelixQA upstream contribution for pkg/evidence.CaptureGeneric (§B.2 caveat):** Lava-side adapter currently bypasses HelixQA's collector for server-side text capture because HelixQA's addItem is unexported. Should we:
- (a) contribute a CaptureGeneric method UPSTREAM to HelixQA (best long-term; needs HelixDevelopment review cycle)
 - (b) ship Lava-side workaround using HelixQA's Item type but bypassing the Collector (faster; technical debt)
6. **Phase 4-C-4 navigator: SKIP or proceed:** Per §B.4, pkg/navigator has weak Go-side justification. Operator approval to skip 4-C-4's navigator entirely vs proceeding with empty plumbing for future use.
7. **§6.AC waiver scope for HelixQA-internal panics:** HelixQA's code MAY panic in degenerate cases (e.g., malformed ADB output). Should Lava's adapters wrap every HelixQA call in recover() + RecordNonFatal? Or trust HelixQA to not panic? (The latter is a bluff unless HelixQA's tests cover panic-free invariants.)
8. **CI build-time budget delta:** §6.T.2 caps test runs at 30-40% host resource. HelixQA's transitive deps (Playwright Go, OpenCV bridges, GStreamer wrappers) may exceed this delta. Operator decision: is a 2x build-time increase acceptable as the cost of Phase 4-C value?
9. **Constitution submodule pin freshness for pkg/evidence API contract:** if HelixQA's pkg/evidence API changes between pin 403603db and the Phase 4-C-1 implementation cycle, the adapter MUST adapt. Operator decision: pin HelixQA at exactly 403603db for Phase 4-C-1 (recommended) vs always-track-upstream (risky per §6.AD pins-frozen rule).
10. **Coverage-ledger row for the adapter set:** Phase 7 (commit c35af27c) generates the §11.4.25 coverage ledger. Phase 4-C adapters add 4 new (feature × platform × invariant) rows. Operator decision: should Phase 4-C-1's commit ALSO bump the coverage ledger, or defer to a Phase 7-followup commit?

H. Cross-references

- docs/plans/2026-05-16-helixqa-integration-design.md — parent (Phase 4 follow-up A) integration design covering all 3 options
- docs/plans/2026-05-15-constitution-compliance.md — parent constitution-compliance plan (Phase 4)
- submodules/helixqa/README.md — HelixQA framework overview
- submodules/helixqa/pkg/detector/detector.go — pkg/detector source (B.1)

- submodules/helixqa/pkg/evidence/collector.go — pkg/evidence source (B.2)
- submodules/helixqa/pkg/navigator/engine.go — pkg/navigator source (B.4)
- submodules/helixqa/pkg/validator/validator.go — pkg/validator source (B.5)
- submodules/helixqa/pkg/ticket/ticket.go — pkg/ticket source (B.3)
- lava-api-go/go.mod — current Go module + replace directives
- lava-api-go/internal/ — existing internal package layout (peer to proposed internal/qa/)
- CLAUDE.md §6.AC — Comprehensive Non-Fatal Telemetry Mandate
- CLAUDE.md §6.AD — HelixConstitution Inheritance (parent inheritance pattern)
- CLAUDE.md §6.AE — Comprehensive Challenge Coverage + Container/QEMU Matrix Mandate
- CLAUDE.md §6.J — Anti-Bluff Functional Reality Mandate
- CLAUDE.md §6.O — Crashlytics-Resolved Issue Coverage Mandate
- CLAUDE.md §6.T.2 — Resource Limits for Tests & Challenges
- HelixConstitution §11.4.17 — Universal-vs-project classification
- HelixConstitution §11.4.27 — 100%-test-type coverage (Phase 4 motivator)
- HelixConstitution §11.4.31 — Inter-submodule dependency manifest

I. Status

Phase 4-C-1: COMPLETED 2026-05-16. Operator approved all 10 §G open questions and Lava-side internal/qa/evidence adapter landed. All §E.1 acceptance criteria met.

Q	Operator decision
Q1	Bump lava-api-go to Go 1.26 (was 1.25)
Q2	WRAP strategy (adapter exposes Lava-shaped methods translating HelixQA types)
Q3	Path A — tag-pin in go.mod; transitional Path B (replace + sibling-mount) active until HelixQA stabilizes
Q4	Preserve HelixQA terminology — adapter type is Collector, NOT renamed
Q5	Contribute CaptureGeneric upstream first → HelixDevelopment/ HelixQA PR #1, branch feat/evidence-capture-generic, commit a1e2020dd759d025b67ef8e024061b103940470d
Q6	SKIP 4-C-4 navigator entirely (no plumbing, no skeleton)
Q7	NO recover() wrapping — trust HelixQA + file upstream improvements if panics surface

Q	Operator decision
Q8	Accept 2x CI build-time increase
Q9	Always-track-upstream for HelixQA pin (§6.AD waiver in root CLAUDE.md)
Q10	Bump coverage ledger in the SAME Phase 4-C-1 commit

Deliverables landed:

- HelixQA pkg/evidence.CaptureGeneric public method + 4 unit tests (HelixQA PR #1, commit a1e2020d)
- lava-api-go/internal/qa/evidence/collector.go (281 LOC) — WRAP-strategy adapter with NewCollector, CaptureText, CaptureFile, Finalize, Items, Count, RunID, OutputDir
- lava-api-go/internal/qa/evidence/collector_test.go (9 tests, 87.9% statement coverage)
- lava-api-go/tests/qa/evidence_test.go (2 real-stack tests, // go:build helixqa_realstack)
- lava-api-go/go.mod: Go 1.26.0 + digital.vasic.helixqa require/replace block addition
- Submodules/HelixQA/ pin advanced b13ba7c0 → a1e2020d
- docs/coverage-ledger.yaml regenerated (58 rows; lava-api-go: 89 unit tests + 1 integration)
- CLAUDE.md Sixth-Law-extensions block: HelixQA always-track-upstream waiver paragraph
- docs/CONTINUATION.md: Phase 4-C-1 row in §1 + HelixQA pin update in §3

§6.J anti-bluff posture (4 falsifiability rehearsals, all reverted):

1. TypeConsoleLog → TypeScreenshot mutation in CaptureText → Item.Type = "screenshot"; want "console_log"
2. all return err → return nil in CaptureFile → expected error for missing source; got nil
3. c.finalized = true → false in Finalize → 3 assertions fired (post-finalize captures got nil instead of ErrFinalized; Count grew)
4. HelixQA-side: if item.Platform == "" → != "" in CaptureGeneric → standalone exerciser fails FAIL: platform default not applied:

Real anti-bluff finding surfaced during implementation: the initial TestCollector_ConcurrentCaptures test caught a production filename-collision bug (millisecond-resolution timestamps + same label letter a at i=0 and i=26 produced identical paths under burst). Production fix: added atomic.Uint64 seq counter to filename template (<runID>-<label>-<ms>-<seq>.txt). The test surfacing a real defect — rather than passing while the bug shipped — is exactly the §6.J posture this clause exists to prove.

Acceptance criteria all met:

-  `go test ./... PASS` for every lava-api-go package including new internal/qa/evidence
-  `go test -tags=helixqa_realstack ./tests/qa/... PASS` (2/2 real-stack tests)
-  §6.AC telemetry coverage: every error path records via observability.RecordNonFatal with mandatory attribute set
-  §6.J falsifiability rehearsals: 4 mutations, 4 reverted, 4 PASS-after-revert
-  `scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh --strict: 40/40 PASS` preserved

Next phases owed: 4-C-2 (detector adapter), 4-C-3 (ticket adapter), 4-C-4 (validator only; navigator SKIPPED per Q6). Each is 1-session scope per §E.

Phase 4-C-2: COMPLETED 2026-05-16. Lava-side internal/qa/detector adapter landed. All §E.2 acceptance criteria met. Operator decisions Q1-Q10 inherited from Phase 4-C-1 (unchanged).

Deliverables landed:

- lava-api-go/internal/qa/detector/detector.go (255 LOC) — WRAP-strategy adapter over HelixQA pkg/detector.Detector. Public API:
 - `type Report struct { Crashed, Alive bool; StackTrace, EvidencePath string }` — Lava-flattened view of HelixQA's DetectionResult (Android-only HasANR + LogEntries + Timestamp intentionally dropped per WRAP minimization)
 - `func New(evidenceDir string, opts ...Option) *Detector` — constructor; `WithCommandRunner(hxqadetector.CommandRunner)` Option for test injection
 - `func (d *Detector) CheckGoProcess(ctx, processName string) (*Report, error)` — name-based detection (`pgrep -f` under the hood)
 - `func (d *Detector) CheckGoProcessByPID(ctx, pid int) (*Report, error)` — PID-based detection (`kill -0 <pid>` under the hood)
 - `func (d *Detector) EvidenceDir() string` — accessor
 - `var ErrEmptyProcessName, ErrInvalidPID error` — Lava-side validation guards (HelixQA silently falls back to `processName="java"` for empty inputs; the adapter rejects them as explicit errors)
- lava-api-go/internal/qa/detector/detector_test.go (11 tests, 82.9% statement coverage, race-clean)
- lava-api-go/tests/qa/detector_test.go (3 real-stack tests, `// go:build helixqa_realstack`) — spawns real sleep child processes,

asserts the REAL HelixQA Detector's `pgrep -f / kill -0` invocations correctly map to Lava-side Report fields

- docs/coverage-ledger.yaml regenerated (58 rows preserved; lava-api-go: 89 → 93 unit tests as expected from internal/qa/detector + parallel agent's internal/qa/ticket additions counted simultaneously)
- docs/CONTINUATION.md Phase 4-C-2 row added

Q5 (upstream contribution) — no work needed. HelixQA's pkg/detector public API already exposes everything the adapter needs (Detector, Option, New, WithDevice/WithPackageName/WithBrowserURL/WithProcessName/WithProcessPID/WithEvidenceDir/WithCommandRunner, Check, CheckApp, Platform, DetectionResult, CommandRunner interface). No HelixQA-side promotion needed for Phase 4-C-2 — contrast with 4-C-1 which had to add CaptureGeneric upstream.

§6.J anti-bluff posture (4 falsifiability rehearsals, all reverted):

1. Crashed: `dr.HasCrash` → `!dr.HasCrash` in `translate()` → 5 unit-test assertions fired: `TestCheckGoProcess_Alive_ReturnsCorrectReport: Report.Crashed = true; want false;`
`TestCheckGoProcess_Dead_ReturnsCrashed: Report.Crashed = false; want true;`
`TestCheckGoProcessByPID_Alive: Report.Crashed = true; want false;`
`TestCheckGoProcessByPID_Dead: Report.Crashed = false; want true;`
`TestTranslate_MappingDirection: translate: Crashed=false; want true (HasCrash=true → Crashed=true)`
2. `strings.TrimSpace(processName) == ""` guard removed from `CheckGoProcess` → compile-error "strings" imported and not used (caught at build time — equally valid §6.J failure signal)
3. `pid <= 0` guard removed from `CheckGoProcessByPID` → 2 sub-test assertions fired: `pid=-1: err = <nil>; want ErrInvalidPID + report = &{... Alive:true ...}; want nil on validation error;`
`pid=0: same.` Forensic note: HelixQA silently falls back to `processName="java"` when PID is non-positive, which exists on most dev machines — the Report would have wrongly reported `Alive=true`. The guard is load-bearing.
4. Alive: `dr.ProcessAlive` → `!dr.ProcessAlive` in `translate()` → all 3 real-stack tests fired in `tests/qa/detector_test.go`:
`TestDetectorAdapter_RealStack_LiveProcess_ReportsAlive: Report.Alive = false; want true (PID 58723 was spawned and not killed) + post-kill: Report.Alive = true; want false (PID 58723 was killed);`
`TestDetectorAdapter_RealStack_NameBasedDetection: Report.Alive = false; want true (sentinel process "lava_api_go_detector_test..." is alive);`
`TestDetectorAdapter_RealStack_GhostProcess_ReportsDead: Report.Alive = true; want false (ghost process "lava-ghost-process-zzzznotreal-xyz" does not exist)`

Honest scope statement (per §6.J / §6.L):

- The real-stack tests in `tests/qa/detector_test.go` were initially executed standalone via `go test -tags=helixqa_realstack ./tests/qa/detector_test.go` (file-target form) while Phase 4-C-3's `internal/qa/ticket/generator.go` was untracked + uncompiling. After Phase 4-C-3 landed at 86402bfa (which gated the HelixQA-side `enhanced_generator.go` behind the `helixqa_enhanced_tickets` build tag — HelixQA SHA bump a1e2020d → c57c275), the full package-target form `go test -tags=helixqa_realstack ./tests/qa/...` PASSES too (7/7 tests: 2 evidence + 3 detector + 2 ticket).
- HelixQA SHA at end of 4-C-2 cycle: c57c275 (advanced by Phase 4-C-3's commit 86402bfa; not by this 4-C-2 commit, which needed NO HelixQA-side change per Q5).
- `scripts/check-non-fatal-coverage.sh` STRICT scans the detector adapter's catch paths — all 5 error paths call `observability.RecordNonFatal` with the canonical attribute set per §6.AC.

Acceptance criteria all met:

-  `go test ./internal/qa/detector/...`: PASS (11 tests, 82.9% coverage, race-clean)
-  `go test -tags=helixqa_realstack ./tests/qa/detector_test.go`: PASS (3/3 real-stack tests; live + dead + ghost process paths via `realpgrep -f` and `kill -0`)
-  §6.AC telemetry coverage: every error path records via `observability.RecordNonFatal` with `feature=qa.detector` + `operation=CheckGoProcess/CheckGoProcessByPID` + `error_class` + relevant context (`process_name` / `pid`)
-  §6.J falsifiability rehearsals: 4 mutations, 4 reverted, 4 PASS-after-revert
-  Q4 terminology preserved: type name `Detector` matches HelixQA's
-  Q7 honoured: no `recover()` wrapping anywhere in the adapter
-  `scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh --strict`: 40/40 PASS preserved (attestation in this commit's run)

Classification: project-specific (Lava's Report shape + the `CheckGoProcess/CheckGoProcessByPID` semantic split + the `ErrEmptyProcessName` + `ErrInvalidPID` Lava-only guards are domain-specific; the WRAP-as-version-isolation pattern is universal per HelixConstitution §11.4.31 — already documented under Phase 4-C-1's classification line).

Next phases owed: 4-C-3 (ticket adapter; in-flight by parallel agent), 4-C-4 (validator only; navigator SKIPPED per Q6).

Phase 4-C-3: COMPLETED 2026-05-16

Operator decisions reused from Phase 4-C-1 (Q1–Q10, all answers unchanged). Q4 confirmed at dispatch time: preserve HelixQA terminology — adapter type is Generator, NOT renamed to ClosureLogWriter.

Deliverables landed:

- HelixQA-side prereq (Q5 equivalent): submodules/helixqa/pkg/ticket/enhanced_generator.go gated behind `//go:build helixqa_enhanced_tickets` so plain consumers of pkg/ticket (like the Lava adapter) do not transitively need the LLMOrchestrator submodule. HelixQA-internal builds + tests opt in via `-tags=helixqa_enhanced_tickets`. HelixQA SHA bump owed at the meta-cycle close.
- `lava-api-go/internal/qa/ticket/generator.go` (~340 LOC) — WRAP-strategy adapter with `NewGenerator`, `GenerateClosureLog`, `OutputDir`, plus `ClosureLogInput` shape mirroring §6.0 closure-log conventions
- `lava-api-go/internal/qa/ticket/generator_test.go` (13 unit tests + 8 slug-sanitization sub-tests, 93.2% statement coverage with `-race`)
- `lava-api-go/tests/qa/ticket_test.go` (2 real-stack tests, `//go:build helixqa_realstack`)
- CLAUDE.md §6.0 extended with clause 7 — programmatic-closure-log adapter authorized; trailer line `Generated by lava-api-go/internal/qa/ticket` provides provenance honesty
- docs/CONTINUATION.md: Phase 4-C-3 row in §1

§6.J anti-bluff posture (2 falsifiability rehearsals, both reverted):

1. Mutated H1 heading from `# Crashlytics issue %s - closure log` → `# Closure record %s in renderClosureLog` → `TestGenerateClosureLog_SchemaMatchesExistingLogs` fails with §6.0 schema heading `"# Crashlytics issue "` missing (test detected the schema break, then revert restored green)
2. Mutated empty-CrashlyticsID validation `return ""`, `ErrEmptyCrashlyticsID` → `return ""`, `nil` in `GenerateClosureLog` → `TestGenerateClosureLog_RejectsEmptyCrashlyticsID` fails with `err = <nil>`; want `qa/ticket: CrashlyticsID is required for closure log` (test detected the silent-write bluff path, then revert restored green)

Real anti-bluff finding surfaced during implementation: the initial adapter design wrapped

`hxqaticket.Generator.GenerateFromStep(g.synthesizeStep(in), in.CrashlyticsID)` to maintain the HelixQA HQA-#### in-memory counter parity. That call required a `*validator.StepResult` which would have cross-coupled Phase 4-C-3 with Phase 4-C-4's validator-adapter territory AND would have built an HQA-#### bookkeeping ticket whose only purpose was

to make the assertion "we are wrapping" look real. The honest §6.J move: drop the synthesize indirection, hold the wrapped `*hxqaticket.Generator` for Phase 4-C-4's future detector→ticket integration, and let the on-disk markdown be the authoritative §6.O artifact. The wrapping is real (the dep edge is live, the type is constructed and held); the rendering is Lava-owned (because §6.O's schema is a Lava concept, not a HelixQA concept). Forcing a fake HelixQA call to "prove the WRAP" would have been a §6.J bluff by construction.

Acceptance criteria all met:

-  `go test ./...` PASS for every lava-api-go package including new `internal/qa/ticket`
-  `go test -tags=helixqa_realstack ./tests/qa/...` PASS (7/7 tests including 2 new ticket-adapter real-stack tests + 3 detector + 2 evidence)
-  §6.AC telemetry coverage: every error path records via `observability.RecordNonFatal` with mandatory attribute set
-  §6.J falsifiability rehearsals: 2 mutations, 2 reverted, 2 PASS-after-revert
-  HelixQA upstream build-tag prereq landed cleanly — `pkg/ticket` builds standalone without `LLMOrchestrator`

Conflict surfaces with sibling worktrees (Phase 4-C-2, Phase 4-C-4):

- `submodules/helixqa/` SHA + governance files: HelixQA worktree's `CLAUDE.md` / `AGENTS.md` / `CONSTITUTION.md` were modified by other agents in parallel; Phase 4-C-3's prereq commit only touches `pkg/ticket/enhanced_generator.go`
- `lava-api-go/internal/qa/detector/` exists as untracked file from Phase 4-C-2 sibling worktree — Phase 4-C-3 did NOT modify it
- `lava-api-go/internal/qa/validator/` will conflict with Phase 4-C-4 if 4-C-4 lands first (no overlap today)
- `lava-api-go/tests/qa/ticket_test.go` is new; `evidence_test.go` + `detector_test.go` (from 4-C-1 / 4-C-2 sibling) untouched
- `docs/coverage-ledger.yaml` row addition: each sibling worktree adds its own `qa/*` package row — expect conflicts at the rolled-up regen
- `docs/CONTINUATION.md` §1 row addition: each sibling worktree adds its own Phase row — expect conflicts at merge
- `docs/plans/2026-05-16-helixqa-go-package-linking-design.md` §1 per-phase section append: each sibling worktree adds its own section — sequential merge will be clean if each appends; concurrent edits at the same line need manual reconciliation

Classification: project-specific (per-package adapter wraps + lava-api-go-specific paths are project-specific; the adapter-layer-as-version-isolation pattern is universal per HelixConstitution §11.4.31).